

# Paula Montano

## Curriculum Vitae

✉ paula.montano1@gmail.com    🌐 github.com/paula-montano    🌐 paula-montano.github.io

## Education

---

2021–2026\*    **Ph.D.** Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin  
2019–2020    **M.Sc.** International Development, University College Dublin  
2011–2016    **B.A.** Business and Foreign Affairs, Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador

## Research Experience

---

2021–today    **PhD Researcher**, Dissertation: *Strategic Crisis Communication: Evidence from the Council of the European Union and National Parliament Negotiations*.  
Advisor: Dr. James P. Cross, School of Politics and International Relations,  
University College Dublin  
2022–today    **Contributor / Research Assistant**, Irish Polling Indicator,  
University College Dublin

## Research

---

### Working Papers & Work in Progress

- *Exceptional Measures for Exceptional Times: Deciphering Emergency Politics in the Council of the European Union* (under review, selected presentations: EUI-ESM Conference on Crisis Communication, EPSA, PSAI)
- *Crisis as a Catalyst for Rebellion: Party Disloyalty and Grandstanding in Parliamentary Debates during Economic Crises* (draft available upon request, selected presentations: Seminar Series School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin)
- *Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union* with James P. Cross and Yen-Chieh Liao (draft available upon request, selected presentations: APSA, EPSA, COMPTXT, SGEU ECPR)

## Datasets

2025    **Irish Demographic Polling Datasets** with Stefan Müller and Thomas Pluck  
**Dashboard:** <https://irishpoliticsdata.shinyapps.io/demographicpolling/>  
**Data:** <https://github.com/Irish-Dem-Polling/datasets>

---

\*Expected doctoral thesis submission August.

2024 **Irish Local and EP Election Manifestos** with Stefan Müller and Artur Baranov  
**Dashboard:** <https://irishpoliticsdata.shinyapps.io/manifestoexplorer/>  
**Data:** <https://github.com/stefan-mueller/iemanifestos>

## Fundings & Awards

---

Total amount of funding: **€133,551**

2021–2025 **UCD Iseult Honohan Doctoral Scholarship**  
University College Dublin School of Politics and International Relations  
(covers full fees €49,284 and living stipend up to four years €80,999)

2025 **Research Grant**  
School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin (€368)

2024 **APSA Pol Com Travel Grant Award**  
Political Communication Section APSA Conference (\$500)

2024 **Vera E. Troeger Scholarship for Women in Political Methodology**  
Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis  
University of Essex (course tuition waiver £1,200)

2024 **Research Grant**  
School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin (€750)

2023 **PEC Travel Grant**  
Political Studies Association of Ireland (€800)

2023 **Research Grant**  
School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin (€600)

2023 **Fellowship for Women in Political Methodology**  
University of Basel (covers full tuition cost and accommodation)

2022 **Research Grant**  
School of Politics and International Relations University College Dublin (€300)

## Teaching

---

### University College Dublin – Undergraduate level

2025 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Foundations of Political Theory* (CODE POL10180)

2022/23/24 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Research Methods in Political Science* (CODE POL20050)

2023/24 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Individuals and the State: The idea of Freedom in the History of Political Thought* (CODE POL20010)

2022 Teaching Assistant, *Introduction to EU Politics* (CODE INRL20160)  
Guest lecturer, *Peer Review and Academic Writing Skills*

2021/22 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Foundations of Political Theory and International Relations* (CODE INRL10010)

## Presentations

---

## Conferences and Workshops

|           |                                                                                                                                |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025      | European University Institute (EUI) - European Stability Mechanism (ESM)   Conference on Crisis Communication, Florence, Italy |
| 2025      | School of Politics and International Relations Seminar Series, University College Dublin                                       |
| 2024      | American Political Science Association Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA, USA                                                |
| 2024      | European Political Science Association Annual Conference, Cologne, Germany                                                     |
| 2024      | 12th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Lisbon, Portugal                                    |
| 2024      | COMPTEXT Annual Conference, Amsterdam, Netherlands                                                                             |
| 2024      | Discourse in the Data PhD Workshop, Duitsland Instituut Amsterdam, Amsterdam, Netherlands                                      |
| 2023      | Political Studies Association of Ireland Annual Conference, Belfast, Northern Ireland                                          |
| 2022/2023 | PhD Workshop, School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin                                        |
| 2022      | Political Studies Association of Ireland Annual Conference, Waterford, Ireland                                                 |

## Summer Schools & Training

---

|      |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | <b>Econometrics</b><br>School of Social Sciences & Law, University College Dublin, (CODE: ECON41820 Audited)                                                                                            |
| 2024 | <b>Ideal Point Estimation, Item Response Theory, and Scaling Methods for Surveys and Behaviour</b><br>Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, University of Essex                          |
| 2023 | <b>Oxford Large Language Models (LLMs) Workshop for Social Science Researchers</b><br>Nuffield College, University of Oxford                                                                            |
| 2023 | <b>Summer School for Women in Political Methodology</b><br>Courses: R packages and Functions, Advanced Graphics in R, Web-Scraping, Text Analysis, Word Embeddings, Images as Data. University of Basel |
| 2022 | <b>Introduction to Quantitative Text Analysis with R</b><br>Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, University of Essex                                                                    |
| 2021 | <b>Cert Higher Education Teaching Support</b><br>University College Dublin                                                                                                                              |

## Skills

---

### Language

English (fluent), French (fluent), German (intermediate), Spanish (native)

## Computational Knowledge

**Programming & Tools:** R, Python, STATA, Git, GitHub, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

**Methods:** Natural Language Processing, Large Language Models, Machine Learning, Text-as-Data

## Academic Service

---

|                     |                                                                                                           |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023/07–<br>2025/08 | PhD Representative, School of Politics and International Relations,<br>University College Dublin          |
| 2022                | Co-organiser, COMPTTEXT Conference, University College Dublin                                             |
| 2022                | Committee Member Diversity & Inclusion for Ad Astra Applicant Pool,<br>University College Dublin          |
| 2021                | Conference Support, Political Studies Association Ireland (PSAI) Conference,<br>University College Dublin |

## Other Experience

---

|                     |                                                                                                              |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020/03–<br>2023/09 | Consular Officer, Embassy of Canada in Ireland, Global Affairs Canada, Dublin,<br>Ireland                    |
| 2018/01–<br>2019/02 | Exports Trainee, Shipco Transports, Supply Chain and Logistics, Chicago, IL, USA                             |
| 2015/02–<br>2017/10 | Passport Examiner/Consular Assistant, Embassy of Canada in Ecuador, Global<br>Affairs Canada, Quito, Ecuador |
| 2015/02–<br>2017/10 | Trainee, Canadian Chamber of Commerce, Quito, Ecuador                                                        |
| 2015/02–<br>2017/10 | Trainee, Mexican Chamber of Commerce, Quito, Ecuador                                                         |

## References

---

Dr. James P. Cross  
Associate Professor, University College Dublin  
james.cross@ucd.ie

---

Last updated: May 6, 2026